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CASE STUDY SUMMARY

Soccer Return-to-Performance

Eight-week applied return-to-performance program

Applied degree project. Hypothetical soccer player returning from a hamstring strain. Summary of the written case study.

FOCUS Sprint Development | Hamstring Considerations | Strength | Conditioning

BRIEF

An 8-week return-to-performance program for a hypothetical soccer player recovering from a hamstring strain, built as an applied programming project for my degree.

APPROACH

I structured the 8 weeks around a graded return to sprinting and match demands, sequencing hamstring-specific strength work, progressive sprint exposure, and conditioning so that load only increased once each prior stage was tolerated well.

RESULTS AND INTERPRETATION

Rather than a single test-day number, the program tracked readiness through staged criteria — pain-free strength testing, tolerance of graded sprint volumes, and reintroduction of change-of-direction work — before progressing to the next block.

RECOMMENDATIONS

I recommended a final on-field, criteria-based assessment — rather than a calendar date — as the trigger for full return to training, in collaboration with a treating physiotherapist.

REFLECTION

Building this program showed me how much return-to-performance depends on sequencing, not just exercise selection — the order and pacing of strength, sprint and conditioning work mattered as much as the exercises themselves.